LITTLE WONDERS ESL

# History Word Lab: Medieval castles

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · moats, towers and drawbridges



## 1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a deep ditch full of water around a castle. I keep enemies out.
2. I am a bridge that guards can lift to stop enemies coming in.
3. I was a soldier on a horse. I wore armour and I fought for my lord.

## 2 COOL FACT: A CASTLE IN THE MIDDLE AGES

In the Middle Ages, which lasted from about 500 to 1500 CE, kings and lords built **castles** to protect their land and people. The first castles were made of wood, but later ones were made of stone. A **moat**, which is a deep ditch full of water, surrounded many castles. To cross it, people used a **drawbridge**, which the guards could lift. Thick **walls** and tall **towers** kept enemies out. Soldiers on top shot arrows through narrow openings. The lord, his family, **knights** and servants lived inside.

**protect** = to keep safe

**ditch** = a long, narrow hole in the ground

**surrounded** = was all around

**servants** = people who work in someone else's home

## 3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

| G | W | A | L | L | S | E | N | F | C | E | S |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| C | H | D | R | A | W | B | R | I | D | G | E |
| V | K | G | N | O | P | F | J | M | T | L | O |
| A | N | S | E | T | I | O | K | O | C | S | M |
| R | I | N | C | A | S | T | L | E | F | T | O |
| R | G | U | D | A | T | T | T | Z | Z | O | A |
| O | H | T | O | W | E | R | A | T | E | N | T |
| W | T | N | J | R | S | O | U | O | O | E | O |

### WORD BANK

- ☐ moat
- ☐ drawbridge
- ☐ knight
- ☐ castle
- ☐ tower
- ☐ wall
- ☐ stone
- ☐ arrow

## 4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. Why did kings build castles?
2. What was a moat?
3. Who lived inside a castle?